Grains & Pasta: Reading · ANSWER KEY

Culinary 1 · Unit 8 · Level 3 (closer to the class work) · goes with Grains & Pasta (Grains, Pasta & Rice PowerPoint and pasta reading)

Name: _____

Grains, Pasta and Rice

A grain is the seed of a grass plant, like wheat, rice, oats, corn and barley. Grains are carbohydrates, which give your body energy. Milling is grinding grain into flour.

A grain kernel has three parts. The bran is the outside skin with lots of fiber. The germ is the small inside part with lots of nutrients. The endosperm is the biggest part and is what white flour is made from.

A whole grain has all three parts, like brown rice, oatmeal and whole wheat bread. A refined grain has the bran and germ removed, like white rice and white bread. Enriched means some nutrients are added back after milling.

Pasta is made from durum wheat. To cook it: boil a big pot of water, add the pasta and stir, cook until al dente (firm to the tooth), then save some pasta water and drain. Dry pasta doubles in size when it cooks. Starchy pasta water, sometimes called liquid gold, helps sauce stick.

Rice is usually cooked with about 2 parts water to 1 part rice. Bring it to a boil, cover, turn the heat to low and do not stir while it simmers.

Check your reading

1. What are the three parts of a grain kernel?
Bran, germ and endosperm.

2. How is a whole grain different from a refined grain?
Whole has all 3 parts; refined has the bran and germ removed.

3. What does al dente mean?
Firm to the tooth: cooked but not mushy.